to the known Mediterranean world in the west. For the south, in addition to internal trade and circuits of exchange, there was exponential growth in overseas trade to the west, and also to the east up to China. The result would be seen in a considerable degree of economic growth and increased prosperity, which is evident from the excavations of cities as well as the descriptions of urban centres in Tamil poetry.

SUMMARY

- In India, after Alexander's death, his general Seleucus Nicator, succeeded to the region across north-western India as a ruler and consequently diplomatic relations were established.
- The Seleucid Empire got weakened and as a result, following a couple of his successors, Menander, the best known of Indo-Greek Kings ruled the empire.
- The Indo-Greek kingdom was ousted by the Sakas followed by the Parthians and the Kushanas. The Sakas appointed kshatraps or provincial governors to administer the territories.
- Rudradaman was the most famous Saka ruler. After him, the Sakas were displaced by the Parthians who were succeeded by the Kushanas.
- The best known of the Kushanas was Kanishka who was an ardent follower of Mahayana form of Buddhism. Gandhara art developed during his period.
- Buddhist philosophers such as Asvaghosha, Parsva, Vasumitra and Nagarjuna were patronised by Kanishka.
- In South India, Satavahana kingdom was established in the first century CE. Muvendar (Chola, Chera and Pandya) were dominant in this region.
- Trade developed between the Tamil country and Rome. Puhar became an important port on Coramandel coast. Yavana merchants lived in port towns.

EXERCISE

8902E

I. Choose the correct answer:

1. _____ was one of the most capable generals of Alexander.
   (a) Seleucus Nicator (b) Antigonus
   (c) Antiochus (d) Demetrius
2. Megasthenes was sent by Seleucus Nicator to the capital Pataliputra as the _____ ambassador.
   (a) Roman (b) Greek
   (c) Chinese (d) British
3. The regular interchange of ambassadors and correspondence_____.
   (a) affected the regular trade from India to the West
   (b) facilitated regular trade from India to the West
   (c) facilitated regular trade from India to the East
   (d) none of the above
4. _____ was the best known of the Indo-Greek kings.
   (a) Euthydemus (b) Demetrius
   (c) Menander (d) Antialcidas
5. Kushana coins were of higher quality than that of _____ coins.
   (a) Roman (b) Greek
   (c) Gupta (d) Satavahana
6. Indo-Greek style of art and sculpture is referred to as _____.
   (a) Mathura art (b) Gandhara art
   (c) Bagh art (d) Pala art
7. Which of the following is not correctly matched?
   (a) *Buddhacharita* - Asvagosha
   (b) *The Periplus of the Erythrean Sea* - Megasthenes
   (c) *Arthasastra* - Kautilya
   (d) *Kamasutra* - Vatsyayana

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